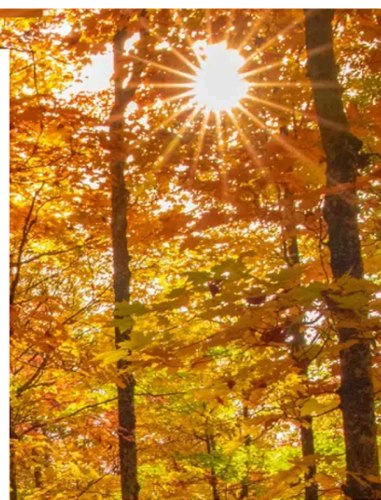


General Knowledge

Indian Geography

STUDY NOTES

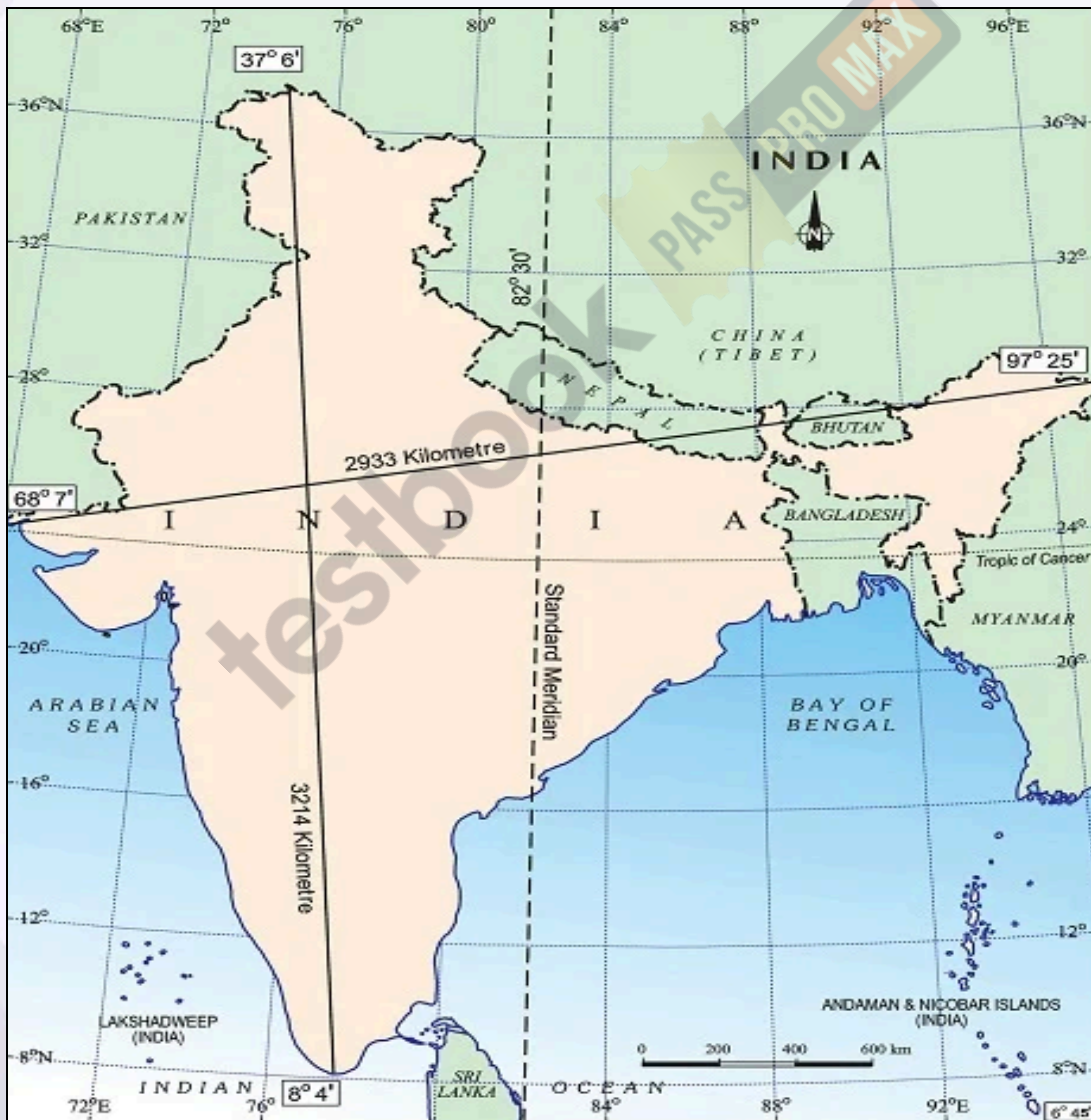
India: Location and Its Size



India Location and Its Size

Introduction

- India is a vast and diverse country located in South Asia. It holds significant **geopolitical**, **economic**, and **cultural** importance on both regional and global levels.
- The country's geographical attributes, such as its **land area**, **strategic location**, and **climate**, shape its domestic and international policies.
- Understanding the geographical context of India is key to comprehending its **political**, **economic**, and **environmental** dynamics.



Top 10 Countries in Terms of Area:

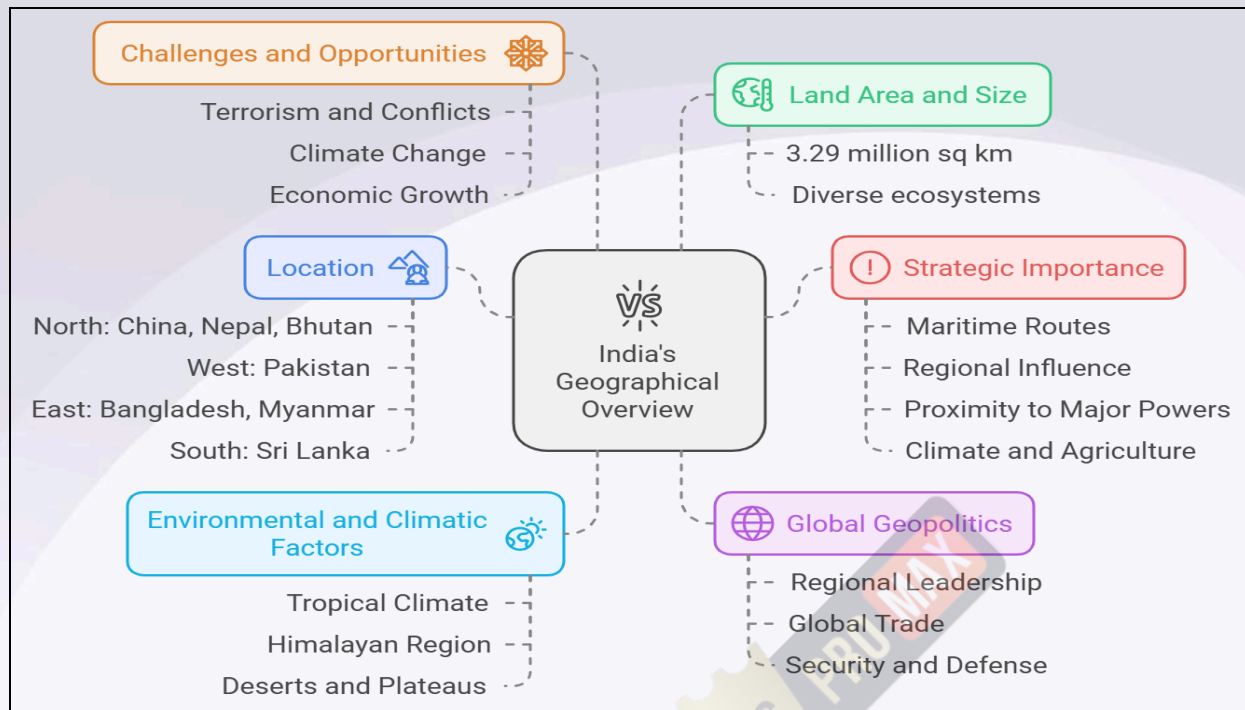
Rank	Country	Area (sq km)	Population (approx.)
1	Russia	17,098,242	146 million
2	Canada	9,984,670	38 million
3	United States	9,826,675	334 million
4	China	9,596,961	1.41 billion
5	Brazil	8,515,767	215 million
6	Australia	7,692,024	26 million
7	India	3,287,263	1.42 billion
8	Argentina	2,780,400	46 million
9	Kazakhstan	2,724,900	19 million
10	Algeria	2,381,741	45 million

Size of India

- India covers an area of **3.287 million square kilometers**, making it the **seventh-largest** country in the world and the largest country in **South Asia**.
- It is larger than the European Union but smaller than **Russia, Canada, and China**.
- It is roughly **2.4** times the size of the U.S. state of Alaska.

Dimensions:

- **Length:** From north to south, India stretches over **3,214 km**.
- **Width:** From east to west, the country spans **2,933 km**.
- **Land Border:** India shares a land border of approximately **15,200 km** with several countries, including **China, Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, and Myanmar**.
- **Coastline:** The total coastline of India is **7,516.6 km**, with two major coastlines:
 - **Western Coast (Arabian Sea)**
 - **Eastern Coast (Bay of Bengal)**
 - Union Territories and States: India consists of **28** states and **8** Union Territories.



Location of India

- **Geographical Coordinates:** India is located between **8°4' N** and **37°6' N** latitudes and **68°7' E** and **97°25' E** longitudes.
- India lies in the **southern part** of Asia, occupying a prominent position on the Indian Subcontinent.
- **Northern Border:** India shares its northern border with **China** and **Nepal** (Himalayan region).
 - The northernmost point of India is **Indira Col** (not to be confused with Indira Point).
 - It is located in the **Siachen Glacier region**, at the **Karakoram Range**, in the **Ladakh region**.
- **Southern Border:** The southernmost point is **Indira Point** in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands (**located just north of the equator**).
- **Western Border:** India shares a western border with **Pakistan**, while the **Arabian Sea** lies to its west.
- **Eastern Border:** The Bay of Bengal lies to the east, with India sharing borders with Bangladesh, Myanmar, and Bhutan to the northeast.
- **Maritime Border:** India shares its maritime borders with **Sri Lanka** and **Maldives**.

Country	Type of Boundary	Length (in kilometers)
Afghanistan	Land Border (North-West)	106
Bhutan	Land Border (North-East)	699
Sri Lanka	Maritime Boundary (Southern)	0 (maritime boundary only)
Myanmar	Land Border (Eastern)	1,643
Nepal	Land Border (Northern)	1,751
Pakistan	Land Border (Western)	3,323
China	Land Border (Northern)	3,488
Bangladesh	Land Border (Eastern)	4,096

Strategic Location

Proximity to Important Water Bodies:

- India is the central figure in the **Indian Ocean** region, which has emerged as a critical zone for **trade, security, and energy** supplies.
- India's location between these seas makes it a crucial **maritime power** in the region.

Geostrategic Importance:

- India's location acts as a bridge between the **Middle East** and **Southeast Asia**, providing it with leverage in international diplomacy and trade.
- The **Strait of Malacca**, a key shipping route, is within India's influence, reinforcing its maritime significance.

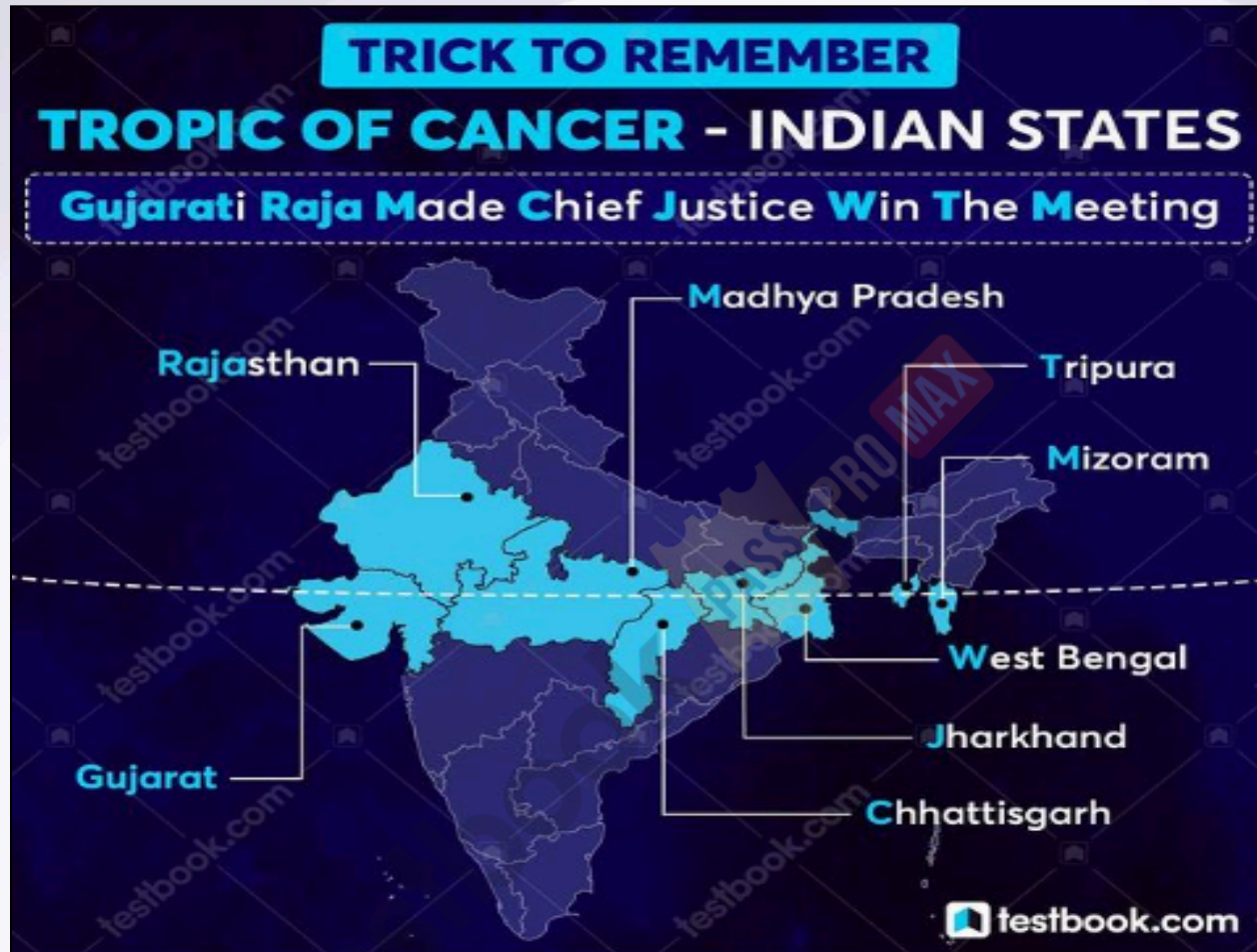
Important Latitudes and Longitudes

Tropic of Cancer (23.5° N)

- Tropic of Cancer** passes through India at **23.5° N latitude**.
- This is a significant latitude as it divides the Earth into the Tropics (**between the Tropic of Cancer and Capricorn**) and marks the **northernmost point** where the Sun is directly overhead during the **summer solstice (around June 21)**.
- India passes through **8 states**, including **Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Mizoram and Tripura**.
- Ujjain**, which lies along the **Tropic of Cancer**, is a significant religious and cultural city in India, home to the **Mahakaleshwar Temple**.

- The **northern part of India**, especially the Himalayan region, falls under the **subtropical zone**, which results in a more **temperate climate** in the northern plains.

States Through Which the Tropic of Cancer Passes:



Significance:

- It marks the boundary of the **tropical region** and has a climatic significance in determining the seasonal changes in India, particularly influencing the Monsoon system.
- It also plays a role in the **agricultural patterns** of the regions it passes through due to the **direct sun angle**.

Prime Meridian (0° Longitude)

- Prime Meridian passes through Greenwich, London, and is the reference for all longitudes.

- While it does not pass through India directly, its role in geographical coordinates is crucial for understanding India's positioning on the globe.

Indian Context:

- India is located **east** of the **Prime Meridian**.
- The standard time for India, known as Indian Standard Time (IST), is based on the time at the **82.5° E longitude**, which is 5 hours 30 minutes ahead of GMT (Greenwich Mean Time).
- The IST Passes through **5** Indian states namely **Uttar Pradesh**., **Madhya Pradesh**, **Chhattisgarh**, **Andhra Pradesh**, and **Orissa**.
- This is India's standard time zone, which places India to the east of the **Prime Meridian**.

